

MidKnight Bites



By: Adrian Hsu, Yancheng Chen, Sebastian Wozny, & Anusha Deshpande

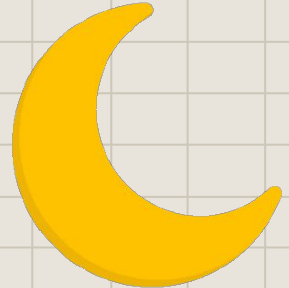
Our Business Concept

Our business concept is a student-run food truck that caters to different campus events, and stays open late during finals and weekends. Many places close at night while college students are still up roaming and hungry. This truck features bright lights and music to attract customers and encourage social interactions, acting as a third place for all students. It would move to different locations across all campuses based on events, such as football tailgates, basketball games, different career fair events, going on that day. It would also be available for rental by on-campus organizations for any formals or events that they have. Students would be able to see where the truck is through an app, similar to XRadars, that would track its live location.



Customer Value Proposition

We bring the party to busy students who deserve a break from their studies and fun that you won't find anywhere else. With music bumping and lights flashing, you can't miss us! We'll brighten your mood like no one else. We offer the widest variety of affordable snacks and hot meals, available anytime and anywhere on campus. The food truck would be student run and it would create employment opportunities on-campus. Additionally, it would be open during late hours when other businesses close, especially on campus such as Livingston. The food truck would travel which sets it apart from other restaurants that have permanent locations.



Our Vision, Mission, and Core Values

Vision: To keep students happy and full, anywhere and anytime.

Mission: “Our mission is to create an accessible and energetic environment for students to enjoy a wide variety of both affordable and delicious food that comes to every corner of campus from sunset to sunrise. We want to be mobile and driven by student demand, creating a one-of-a-kind experience for students.”

Core Values:

Community: being an inclusive environment for students of all backgrounds

Accessibility: going to every campus and responding to student demand

Sustainability: being conscious of our environmental impact and not creating waste

Adaptability: responding to changes in an innovative and receptive manner

Quality: always serving fresh, tasty food that students can count on

Affordability: keeping prices fair so every student can enjoy

Financial and Strategic Objectives

Financial Objectives

1. Achieve a positive net cash flow by the end of year two of operation.
2. Cut the costs of total expenses by 10% before June 2026.
3. Reach break-even within 9 months by serving at least 100 customers per night.

Strategic Objectives

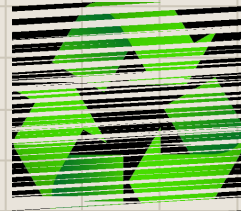
1. Grow a following of 1,000 on Instagram by the end of the 2025-2026 school year
2. Partner with at least 10 student organizations by the end of year one of operation
3. Build a loyal customer base of at least 500 repeat student customers (measured by student ID loyalty program) by the end of the first year.

Corporate Social Responsibility

Eco-friendly packaging - We can reduce the carbon footprint of our truck and show our commitment to environmental responsibility.

Donating portions of profits to local charities - We can show our commitment to giving back by supporting the local community.

Food waste reduction through donation - We can reduce waste and help with food insecurity in surrounding areas.



Our New Service

We will launch a rewards systems for MidKnight Bites customers...

- Tracking customer purchases and engagement
- Customers can accumulate points per dollar spent
- Eventually use those points on our store products
- Incentivize customers to revisit and strengthen their loyalty.



National Expansion: Decision, Approach, Rationale

We decided to expand our business nationally.

Expanding nationally will give our business the opportunity to potentially grow a lot more. We can span across numerous college campuses and attract way more customers that way.

We decided the best approach for expanding nationally is by franchising.

We would be able to expand quickly and with less financial burden than if we were to raise the capital ourselves. We could use legal contracts to our advantage to ensure brand reputation.



Selected Country: Canada

- **Opportunities:** Large student/university population, culturally similar to the US, good legal system and protections, stable economy
- **Challenges:** Different regulations based on province, weather challenges based on region, retail theft, economic worries with US trade policies
- **Overall Rationale:** Canada has a similar culture and large student population that would be the target demographic of our business. It would be the most similar to the US which would make the transition easier, and managing any challenges easier and closer proximity.



Expansion + Entry Strategies and Rationale

Expansion Strategy – Combo Strategy:

- We will keep our brand standardized across locations while allowing modest local menu customization to fit Canadian preferences.

Entry Strategy – Franchising:

- Franchising enables rapid national growth with lower capital requirements and ensures brand consistency through clear operational guidelines.

Rationale:

- This approach balances efficiency and local appeal. Standardization protects brand identity and quality, while small local menu adaptations (e.g., poutine-inspired items) enhance cultural fit and customer acceptance in Canada. Franchising allows faster expansion, reduced financial risk, and easier replication of our business model.



Key Job Overview: Chef

Key Responsibilities

- Prepare high quality meals
- Follow all safety and cleanliness protocols.
- Communicate with cashiers and waiters

Required Qualifications

Strong communication skills

1+ year(s) of prior kitchen experience

Ability to work in a fast paced environment

Compensation Plan

\$22.50 an hour

Free meal on shift days

Company sponsored training provided

Criteria for Candidates to Interview

- Prior work experience
- Flexible hours
- Strong interest in food preparation
- Strong resume

Advertising Plan for recruiting

- Post job offerings online through Instagram, TikTok, and various job websites
- Focus on marketing around culinary schools
- Put up flyers in the local area

Employee Motivation Initiatives

- **Rewards program** - gift cards and prepaid cards to employee of the month
- **Career development** - financial and training support for employees
- **Shift preferences** - more leeway with preferred hours because of late night hours
- **Check-ins** - brief meetings to discuss employee status
- **Team engagement events** - team dinners and fundraiser to boost employee comradery



Departure of Employees Announcement



Dear MidKnight Bites Team,

I hope you are all doing well. I want to share that (Employee Names) are pursuing new opportunities and will no longer be continuing with the MidKnight Bites Team. We appreciate all that they have done, and wish them all the best in their future endeavors.

We value our employees, and to make sure our team continues to feel supported and valued we are introducing several new employee initiatives.

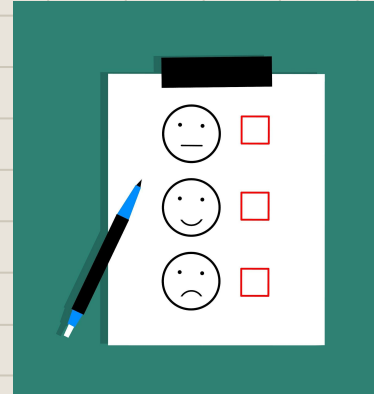
- Employee of the month
- Team building
- Employee discounts and more!
- Paid developmental opportunities
- Monthly team dinners

Here at MidKnight Bites, your opinion matters. Please feel free to reach out with any new ideas or suggestions. Thank you for all you do for this team, your hard work and dedication does not go unnoticed!

Best regards,
(General Manager Name)

Key Actions for High Employee Engagement

- Quarterly employee surveys
- Professional certification reimbursement
- Mentorship program with new hires
- Employee newsletter for recognition



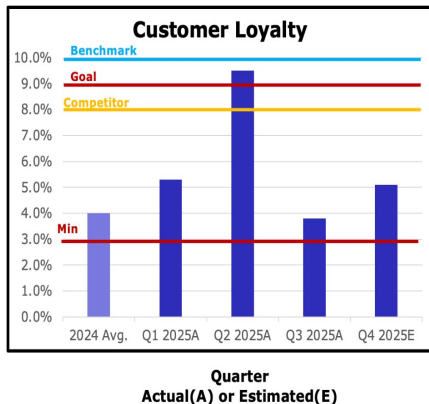
SIPOC for key process

Suppliers	Inputs	Process	Outputs	Customers
• Food Wholesalers • Local Labor Market • Beverage Wholesalers	• Fresh ingredients • Truck equipped with POS system, kitchen, work area, supplies • Experienced chefs	• Create menu • Prepare kitchen • Buy ingredients and supplies • Take orders • Organize partnerships • Prepare food • Serve customers food	• Good quality and tasting food • Friendly and efficient customer service • Reasonable prices	• Who: college students • Desired Customer Behaviors: repeat business, social media shares, event bookings • Customer requirements: delicious food, timely delivery, good value

Effectiveness and Efficiency Measurement Charts

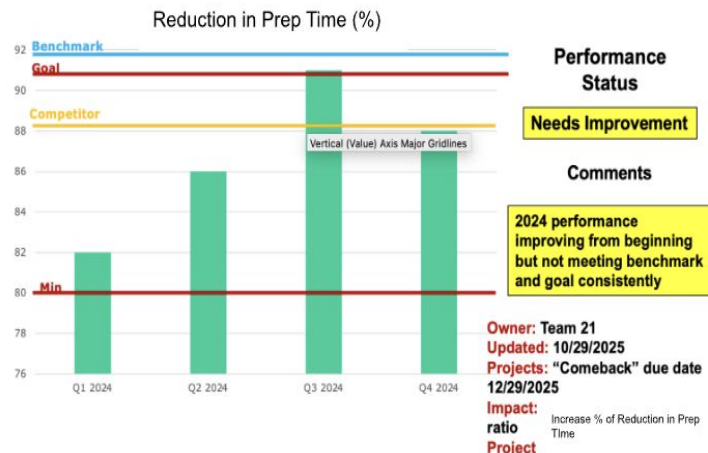
Well-Dressed Measure – Late Knight Bite

% Increase
In Loyal
Customers
Vs Prior Qtr.
(Measured by
counting the
number of
customers who
say they have
been here
before and
comparing total
to prior quarter)



Owner: Team 21
Updated: 10/29/2025
Projects: "Comeback" due date 12/29/2025
Impact: Increase 10% per Qtr. by y/e 2021
Project Mgr: Knight

Increase % in
Reduction of Prep
Time



Key Initiative: Improving Effectiveness

Expanded Menu Variety

- Cater to dietary restrictions
- Have different cuisines in one place
- Appeal to a broad audience

Loyalty Rewards System

- Incentivize returning customers
- Discounts over time
- Build brand loyalty

Feedback Survey

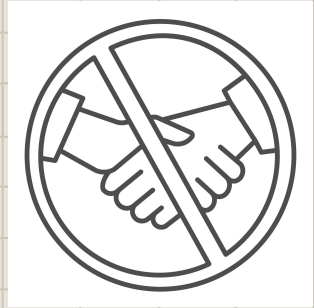
- Offer free food item on next purchase for feedback
- Make customer voices heard

Team Decision: Not to Sell

Our team has decided not to sell the business

As a U.S. based and created business, we should keep ownership in the US.

- We can maintain our brand reputation
- Not cause job losses for our loyal employees
- Reduce the risk of losing long term profits
- Reduce risk of disruptions in the service and supply chain.



The new owners lack experience and we are not confident in their abilities to operate the business that we built from the ground up. We instead will focus on expanding our product offerings and strengthening our partnerships.

Why Our Business Has Been Successful

- Working with each other and getting the “Right Work, Done Well”
- Focused on maintaining our brand reputation and building brand loyalty
- Prioritized continuous improvement and innovation
- Made our customers feel seen and heard through services and initiatives
- Focused on employee engagement and building loyalty with our employees

